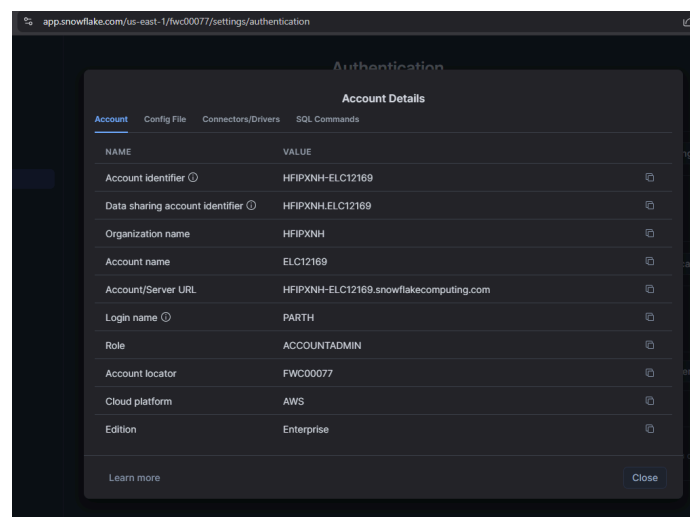


1. Creating a Snowflake Account (Steps)

Snowflake is a cloud-based data platform, and account creation is done through the official Snowflake website.

Step-by-step process, I followed :-

1. **Visited Snowflake website**
 - Go to: <https://signup.snowflake.com>
2. **Started with free trial**
 - Choose a cloud provider (AWS / Azure / GCP)
3. **Filled in registration details**
 - Name, email address, company details
 - Country/region and contact information
4. **Select Snowflake edition**
 - Choose options like Standard, Enterprise, or Business Critical (trial usually starts with Standard)
5. **Create account credentials**
 - Username
 - Password
 - Account identifier is automatically generated (important for SnowSQL connection)
6. **Verify email**
 - Snowflake sends a verification link to your email
7. **Log in to Snowsight (Web UI)**
 - After activation, log in at <https://app.snowflake.com>
8. **Access your Snowflake environment**



2. Connecting to Snowflake using SnowSQL

SnowSQL is the **command-line interface (CLI)** used to connect to Snowflake.

Step-by-step installation and connection:

Step 1: Install SnowSQL

- Download SnowSQL from Snowflake official documentation
- Install it based on your OS (Windows/macOS/Linux)

Step 2: Connect using SnowSQL command in cmd

Use the following syntax:

```
snowsql -a <account_identifier> -u <username>
```

Step 4: Enter password

- You will be prompted to enter your password securely (not passed in command line)

Step 5: Successful connection

- If credentials are correct, SnowSQL opens a session like:

```
C:\Users\parthk.shah>snowsql -a HFIPXNH-ELC12169 -u PARTH
Password:
* SnowSQL * v1.5.0
Type SQL statements or !help
PARTH@COMPUTE_WH@(<no database>).(no schema)>SHOW DATABASES;
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
| created_on | options | retention_time | name | is_default | is_current | origin | owner | comment |
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
| 2026-05-26 03:37:25.145 -0700 | 1 | 0700 | PRACTICE_DB | N | N | NULL | ACCOUNTADMIN | |
| 2026-05-25 02:56:02.820 -0700 | 0 | 0700 | SNOWFLAKE | N | N | SNOWFLAKE_ACCOUNT_USAGE | ACCOUNTADMIN | |
| 2026-05-25 02:56:06.485 -0700 | 0 | 0700 | APPLICATION | N | N | NULL | ACCOUNTADMIN | |
| 2026-05-25 02:56:06.485 -0700 | 0 | 0700 | SNOWFLAKE_SAMPLE_DATA | N | N | SFSALESSHARED_SFC_SAMPLES_V44_SAMPLE_DATA | ACCOUNTADMIN | Preloaded TPCH Data provided by Snowflake during account provision |
| 2026-05-25 04:33:17.846 -0700 | 1 | 0700 | IMPORTED_DATABASE | N | N | NULL | ACCOUNTADMIN | |
| 2026-05-25 04:33:17.846 -0700 | 1 | 0700 | USERSPARTH | N | N | NULL | ACCOUNTADMIN | |
| 2026-05-25 04:33:17.846 -0700 | 1 | 0700 | PERSONAL_DATABASE | N | N | NULL | ACCOUNTADMIN | |
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
4 Row(s) produced. Time Elapsed: 0.457s
```

3. Snowflake Web UI vs SnowSQL Comparison

Overview

Snowflake provides two main ways to interact with the platform:

- **Web UI (Snowsight)** – browser-based interface
- **SnowSQL** – command-line interface (CLI)

Feature Comparison

Feature	Web UI (Snowsight)	SnowSQL (CLI)
Interface type	Graphical (browser-based)	Text-based terminal
Ease of use	Very beginner-friendly	Requires command knowledge
Setup	No installation required	Must install SnowSQL client
Query execution	SQL editor in browser	SQL via terminal commands
Data visualization	Built-in dashboards & charts	No visualization
Performance monitoring	Available via UI dashboards	Limited / manual queries
Automation	Limited	Strong (scripts & batch jobs)
File/data loading	UI-based upload wizard	Supports bulk loading via commands
Multi-tasking	Easy switching tabs	Requires multiple terminal sessions
Best for	Beginners, analytics, dashboards	Developers, automation, bulk operations